



AFP PHOTO

SECURITY LAPSES: State-level policing is still not geared to tackle terrorism after so many strikes

hanged if found guilty. "If my son is involved, then he should be punished in front of us. We will not stop him from being hanged too, if he is found guilty," she said, insisting that her son was innocent and could not have done such acts. Intelligence sources, however, have established that he had played multiple roles in the recent blasts, using his IT expertise to hack into unguarded WiFi networks to send e-mails and warnings to media outlets minutes before the blasts took place. The police believe that he is also the bomb maker, using microchips as timers in Bangalore and improvised bomb devices in Ahmedabad and Delhi. Frighteningly, interrogations of those arrested post-Ahmedabad suggest that there is a core leadership group of which Tauqeer is the only one identified so far. Nagori told his interrogators that, "Tauqeer may be a member of this group about which none of us know much." Interrogations reveal that he issued orders after

the Hyderabad blasts, saying: "We should never commit such acts in Hyderabad and Pune". This suggests that these two cities have emerged as key centres for IM's planning and strategic operations.

The intelligence gathered so far also indicates that IM has made significant inroads into the Muslim community with its brand of puritanical Islam as propagated by bin Laden. Till his arrest in March in Indore, the movement was being led by Nagori, Tauqeer, and Bashir, who is the organisation's Zimmewar or president. After Tauqeer and Nagori, the most important leader is Bashir. An Islamic preacher from Azamgarh, he is one of the main ideologues of the IM. There are others in the hierarchy (*see box*), which is increasingly getting corporatised.

What is scary is just how powerful this rechristened SIMI organisation has become. Details that the four arrested leaders have given out under interrogation suggest a large, pan-India network with various coded categories, according to their role in the terror plots (*see box*) with connections to terror groups like HUL and LeT. Nagori admitted that IM has received funds from the LeT in the past. Most of these outfits, except The White Falcon which was floated

What is SCARY is how POWERFUL the rechristened SIMI organisation in the form of IM has become.